

Aptitude, Reasoning & Verbal Ability — Placement Preparation Topics

A structured topic checklist for campus/company placement tests

1. Quantitative Aptitude

Arithmetic

- Number System (HCF/LCM, divisibility, remainders)
- Percentages
- Profit & Loss
- Simple & Compound Interest
- Ratio, Proportion & Variation
- Average
- Mixtures & Alligations
- Time & Work (incl. pipes & cisterns)
- Time, Speed & Distance (incl. boats/streams, trains, races)
- Ages

Algebra

- Linear & Quadratic Equations
- Progressions (AP, GP, HP)
- Surds & Indices
- Logarithms
- Inequalities

Geometry & Mensuration

- Lines, Angles, Triangles, Circles
- Areas & Volumes (2D/3D shapes)
- Coordinate Geometry (basics)
- Trigonometry (basics)

Modern Math / Data-based

- Permutations & Combinations
- Probability
- Set Theory & Venn Diagrams
- Data Interpretation (tables, bar/line/pie charts, caselets)
- Data Sufficiency

2. Logical Reasoning

- Blood Relations
- Direction Sense
- Coding-Decoding
- Series (Number, Alphabet, Alphanumeric)
- Analogy
- Classification (Odd One Out)
- Syllogisms
- Seating Arrangement (Linear & Circular)
- Puzzles (Box/Floor/Grid-based, Scheduling)
- Statement & Assumptions / Arguments / Conclusions
- Course of Action
- Cause and Effect
- Data Sufficiency (logical)
- Clocks & Calendars
- Cubes and Dice
- Venn Diagrams (logical)
- Input-Output Reasoning
- Ranking & Ordering
- Inequalities (logical, e.g., $A > B < C$)

3. Verbal Ability

- Reading Comprehension
- Vocabulary (Synonyms, Antonyms, One-word substitution)
- Analogies (verbal)
- Sentence Correction / Error Spotting
- Sentence Completion / Fill in the Blanks
- Para Jumbles (Sentence Rearrangement)
- Cloze Test
- Idioms & Phrases
- Spelling & Homophones
- Active-Passive Voice, Direct-Indirect Speech
- Prepositions, Articles, Tenses (grammar basics)
- Critical Reasoning (verbal arguments)

4. Non-Verbal Reasoning

- Series (Figural/Image-based)
- Analogy (Figural)
- Classification (Figural Odd One Out)
- Mirror Images
- Water Images
- Paper Folding & Cutting
- Embedded Figures
- Figure Formation & Analysis
- Pattern Completion
- Counting Figures (triangles, squares, etc.)
- Cubes and Dice (visual)
- Grouping of Images

Suggested Prep Approach

1. Start with **Quant fundamentals** (percentages, ratios, TSD, time & work) — these feed into most other topics.
2. Practice **logical puzzles & arrangements** daily — they take the most time to get fast at.
3. Build a **vocabulary habit** (daily words) alongside grammar rules for Verbal.
4. Non-verbal reasoning needs less time — a few practice sets to get pattern-familiar is usually enough.
5. Do **timed mock tests** per company (TCS NQT, Infosys, Wipro, Capgemini, etc. all have slightly different weightages) once comfortable with basics.